

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - July 30, 2026

Compiled summary for Thursday, July 30, 2026 - focus: continued PrahL.dev Portfolio landing-page and Alla Vostra project-page refinement after the July 29 hero/social/case-study pass, including narrow mobile nav and profile-photo sizing, removal of responsive text stretching, featured case-study row synchronization, text-only PLATFORM/DEVICE metadata, Cinerific promo-card imagery, PrahL.dev card de-emphasis, Alla Vostra GitHub button restyling, checkout-stage label cleanup, local dev-cache handling, static-export validation, refreshed project snapshot context, review of all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generation of the daily Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers only Prahl/portfolio work performed for the July 30 Eastern-time design session after portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf: source commit 15d84ec from Thursday, July 30, 2026 at 19:57:19 EDT, source commit 8868c1a from Thursday, July 30, 2026 at 21:15:38 EDT, repeated local dev-cache and preview handling, validation checks, the refreshed project snapshot, and this worklog-generation step. Alla Vostra, Cinerific, and Credit King application repositories were not changed for this record.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, including project notes, current source tree, line-numbered source dumps, tooling and deployment configuration, public image inventory, root-level PDF inventory, git context, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf, and portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf.
- Extracted text from all thirteen existing Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext to preserve the same title cadence, opening-summary density, section order, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.
- Used portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf as the closest same-project reference because it documented the latest hero/social/case-study visual pass, source-snapshot refresh behavior, late-session date handling, local dev-cache reset language, PDF metadata expectations, and current root-level naming convention.
- Checked mature PDF metadata with pdftinfo and confirmed the current Portfolio artifacts use letter-size pages, Helvetica/Helvetica-Bold base fonts, compact five-to-six page bodies, root-level filenames, and Codex standard-library PDF-generator metadata.
- Reviewed Git history through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, branch state, and the committed scopes for 15d84ec and 8868c1a. HEAD and origin/main both resolved to 8868c1a before this PDF was generated.
- Reviewed app/CaseDescription.tsx, app/CaseGridLayoutSync.tsx, app/HeroLede.tsx, app/page.tsx, app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/globals.css, app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx, package.json, read_project.sh, and the root-level PDF inventory before generating this artifact.
- Checked the running local development routes at http://127.0.0.1:3000/ and http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra and confirmed both returned 200 OK from the

Next.js dev server.

Baseline Status Before July 30 Work

- The July 29 Portfolio source already had baked LinkedIn and Resume social labels, refined hero proof and chip behavior, restored original case-study title typography, and the first PLAT:/FACTOR case-study metadata direction.
- The featured case-study cards were still being tuned live against very narrow aspect ratios. Text stretching, forced kerning, early wrapping, and invisible clipping edges made the paragraph and title rows feel different from the Stack and Worklog cards.
- The platform and form-factor metadata was still moving from icon-heavy PLAT:/FACTOR language into clearer text-only rows. The user wanted PLATFORM and DEVICE vocabulary, then a stricter row model and right-edge alignment for the headings and values.
- The one-word and two-word case-study project names needed card-to-card vertical alignment that was driven by a stable metadata row, not by project-title height. Without that, one-word titles could sit too close to paragraph text when other cards wrapped differently.
- Cinerific still needed its featured-card image swapped from the intro logo frame to the same promo image visible in the landing hero device frame, then cropped to match the three-image Alla Vostra stack height.
- The PrahL.dev featured card still visually competed with the central project cards and still carried a parenthetical THIS WEBSITE label that the user later wanted removed.
- The Alla Vostra dedicated page still used the generic green primary GitHub buttons with lucide braces, while the landing page already had a more specific black GitHub treatment with a custom braces mark and stroked label text.
- The Alla Vostra Product Flow stage names and numbering still reflected Customer Details and a Stage 02 starting offset that no longer matched the desired user-facing flow language.

Goals for July 30

- Keep the narrowest mobile profile-photo and top navigation behavior responsive without disturbing wider aspect ratios that had already been approved.
- Remove responsive text stretching and kerning from landing hero labels and featured case-study descriptions so words wrap naturally instead of being horizontally distorted.
- Make featured case-study paragraphs mimic the natural Stack/Worklog card text behavior, avoiding invisible clipping boundaries while preserving padding and professional line flow.
- Synchronize the vertical placement of featured case-study topline, project titles, platform/device rows, paragraphs, chips, and image stacks across every card.
- Move the PLATFORM/DEVICE metadata into its own card row between project title and paragraph, keep the label/value rows horizontal, align the heading right edges, and add the requested centered vertical divider between headings and values.
- Increase featured case-study project-name typography to the requested final 40px state while preventing single-card portrait layouts from wrapping project names prematurely.
- Replace Cinerific featured-card artwork with the landing-hero Cinerific promo image, match its width to Alla Vostra, and crop its vertical height to match the three-image stack.
- Reduce PrahL.dev card emphasis while preserving its hover behavior, remove the THIS WEBSITE label, and keep PrahL.dev visually subordinate to the central project cards.
- Restyle Alla Vostra GitHub buttons to match the landing-page GitHub treatment while preserving dedicated-page button dimensions, layout, and action-row behavior.
- Rename the Alla Vostra flow stage to Checkout, update the matching expandable button text, and reduce displayed Stage 0x numbers by one.

Work Completed - Responsive Text and Featured Card Row Sync

- Tightened the mobile-only profile-photo treatment by scaling the narrowest-mode profile bubble while leaving the approved narrow aspect-ratio behavior intact.
- Added a responsive mobile nav height clamp so the PrahL.dev border box hugs the green P-box in very narrow layouts and expands back toward the established height as the viewport becomes wide enough for the CTA and social controls.
- Simplified HeroLede from client-side per-character fitting to plain line spans so the hero

- lede no longer applies responsive horizontal scaling or live letter stretching.
- Removed per-letter Check Out Projects rendering and the measured hero-view-stack width dependency from app/page.tsx and ProjectCarouselButton.tsx so hero button-label typography no longer depends on stretching calculations.
- Rebuilt CaseDescription as a simple server component that renders one natural paragraph from the provided text lines, eliminating line-scale and word-spacing calculations that caused featured-card descriptions to behave differently from Stack card text.
- Added CaseGridLayoutSync as a client synchronization component for non-article featured case-study grids, measuring row margin-box heights after layout, resize, font readiness, and ResizeObserver events.
- Expanded the row synchronization model to include topline, title, device metadata, description, tags, and media rows so all featured cards share consistent vertical reference points even when titles or copy wrap differently.
- Scoped the synchronized CSS grid rows to .case-grid-featured > .case-card so the landing featured cards receive the row alignment behavior without rewriting the article-card grid or unrelated sections.
- Added a shared title/device gap variable so the project-title row and the PLATFORM/DEVICE metadata row preserve matching vertical gap behavior while still participating in synchronized row measurements.

Work Completed - Platform/Device Metadata and Card Visuals

- Converted the featured-card platform/factor display from icon-based PLAT:/FACTOR treatments into text-only PLATFORM and DEVICE rows with AND, IOS, WEB, PHONE, and TABLET values.
- Moved the device metadata out of the project-title h3 and into its own direct card row between the project name and paragraph text, making it easier to synchronize the metadata row across cards.
- Updated the metadata grid to direct row placement instead of display: contents wrapper placement, so PLATFORM values occupy row 1 and DEVICE values occupy row 2 without collapsing back into one combined row.
- Aligned the PLATFORM and DEVICE heading right edges while letting the whole two-row stack start from the left edge of the heading column, matching the user requested heading/value relationship.
- Added a 1px vertical divider in the same mint color as the metadata text, centered between the PLATFORM/DEVICE headings and the value words, without increasing the total horizontal gap footprint.
- Raised featured case-study project-name typography through the requested tuning sequence and settled the restored original-card project names at 40px with normal letter spacing, no stroke, and no decorative shadow.
- Protected featured project names from wrapping in one-card portrait layouts unless a standalone word truly cannot fit inside the card padding.
- Removed the Prahlin.dev THIS WEBSITE label and deleted its unused CSS, leaving the project title cleaner and avoiding hidden title-stack spacing artifacts.
- Reduced the Prahlin.dev featured card to half opacity by default and matched its hover state to the standard case-card hover look, so it reads as less central while still behaving interactively.
- Swapped the Cinerific featured-card screenshot from cinerific-intro.png to cinerific_promo.png, added explicit image dimensions, and gave Cinerific a dedicated miniature class for precise card-level image sizing.
- Matched the Cinerific featured-card image width to the combined width of the Alla Vostra three-image card stack and cropped its top/bottom through an aspect-ratio and container-query height rule so its visible height aligns with Alla Vostra.

Work Completed - Alla Vostra Dedicated Page

- Added a local ProjectGitHubMark SVG to app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx so the dedicated page can use the same custom braces concept as the landing GitHub button without importing the landing page component.

- Restyled both Alla Vostra GitHub links with project-github-button and github-button classes, preserving the project-page .button sizing, padding, layout, and action positioning while adopting the black GitHub surface and stroked GitHub label treatment.
- Changed the Alla Vostra GitHub label from View GitHub through user-directed iterations to the final View GitHub Project wording, updating both the visible text and data-text attribute used by the layered stroke effect.
- Inverted the project GitHub icon asset so the braces mark became white on a black box, removed the white border, grew the icon to hug the 48px button height, and tuned the brace separation to a 50 percent wider horizontal gap.
- Scaled the Alla Vostra GitHub button label text to the accepted 21px state, keeping the icon size and button frame stable after the text-size adjustment.
- Renamed the former Customer Details flow group to Checkout and updated the matching initial-stack conditional so the expandable section still opens with the same intended number of visible stacks.
- Allowed the expandable button labels to follow the renamed group automatically, producing More Checkout Screens and Hide Checkout Screens without special-case copy.
- Reduced every displayed Stage 0x card number in the Alla Vostra flow groups by one by changing the rendered offset from index + 2 to index + 1, leaving the content ordering itself unchanged.

Work Completed - Commit Handling and Local State

- Committed and pushed 15d84ec, Refined featured case study layout and responsive text behavior, covering the narrow nav/profile adjustments, removal of text-stretching logic, featured-card paragraph behavior, and synchronized row sizing.
- Committed and pushed 8868c1a, Refined case-study cards and Alla Vostra project page, covering the final featured-card metadata row, Cinerific/Prahl.dev visual treatments, Alla Vostra GitHub button restyling, Checkout flow labels, and stage-number adjustment.
- Confirmed the final source branch state had HEAD and origin/main both at 8868c1a0deabba51389858f0d572d11235c36093 before this PDF was generated.
- Cleared the Next dev cache during the visual iteration sequence and restarted the local development server in a detached screen session named portfolio-dev after plain background launches exited under the tool runner.
- Kept the refreshed project snapshot and this worklog PDF local as documentation artifacts pending a separate user-approved commit message, consistent with the standing no-commit-without-approval preference.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Ran npm run check after the current July 30 source state and confirmed TypeScript validation passed with tsc --noEmit.
- Ran npm run build:static and confirmed the local Next.js static export completed successfully, compiling, running TypeScript, collecting page data, generating six static pages, and finalizing page optimization.
- Confirmed http://127.0.0.1:3000/ returned 200 OK from the running local Next.js dev server.
- Confirmed http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra returned 200 OK from the same local dev server after the dedicated-page button and flow-label changes.
- Confirmed lsof showed node listening on TCP port 3000 and screen -ls showed the detached portfolio-dev screen session still present.
- Checked git rev-parse HEAD and git rev-parse origin/main and confirmed both returned 8868c1a0deabba51389858f0d572d11235c36093 before generating this worklog.
- Checked git show --stat and git show --name-status for 15d84ec and 8868c1a to verify the committed source scope documented in this PDF.
- Regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before this PDF so the current source tree, recent commits, file inventory, PDF inventory, and public sync context were represented locally.
- Restored next-env.d.ts after npm run build:static flipped the route-types import from .next/dev/types/routes.d.ts to .next/types/routes.d.ts, keeping build validation from

leaving unrelated generated-file noise.

- Generated this PDF with the same standard-library PDF writer style used by the mature Portfolio worklogs and checked metadata/text extraction after writing.

Files Touched During July 30 Portfolio Work

- app/CaseDescription.tsx - simplified the featured-card description renderer from a client-side line-fitting component into natural paragraph output matching the Stack/Worklog card text behavior.
- app/CaseGridLayoutSync.tsx - added and then refined the featured-card row synchronization component so title, device metadata, description, tags, media, and topline rows share measured heights across cards.
- app/HeroLede.tsx - removed per-character hero lede fitting and responsive font-scaling logic so hero lede text no longer stretches during viewport changes.
- app/page.tsx - removed per-letter Check Out Projects rendering and the now-unneeded measured hero-view stack width dependency.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - converted featured-card platform/device metadata to text-only rows, removed card metadata icons, added direct grid row classes, inserted the vertical metadata divider, and removed stale measurement behavior.
- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - rendered CaseGridLayoutSync for featured cards, moved device metadata out of h3 title nodes, removed the PrahL.dev THIS WEBSITE label, added Cinerific promo image dimensions, and assigned per-project miniature classes.
- app/globals.css - tuned mobile nav and profile-photo behavior, featured-card grid rows, project-name typography, metadata row spacing/alignment/divider styling, Cinerific card image crop rules, PrahL.dev card opacity/hover behavior, and Alla Vostra project GitHub button styling.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx - added the custom project GitHub mark, restyled both GitHub buttons, tuned the icon colors/scale/brace gap, changed the button text to View GitHub Project, renamed the flow group to Checkout, and reduced displayed stage numbers by one.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated by ./read_project.sh for this worklog pass and left modified locally as the current project-context artifact.
- portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf - generated as this daily Portfolio worklog artifact in the root-level Portfolio worklog convention.

Follow-Up Context

- The public source branch is already represented by origin/main at 8868c1a, and the July 30 source changes have been pushed to main.
- The refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and this July 30 PDF remain local until the user provides or approves a commit message for documentation artifact changes.
- Because this PDF increases the Portfolio root-level worklog artifact count from 13 to 14, visible public copy can be updated later only if the user wants exact Portfolio worklog inventory reflected in card or proof-stat copy.
- The featured case-study metadata is now intentionally text-only and divided into PLATFORM and DEVICE rows. Future edits should preserve the separate synchronized row unless the user asks to reopen the card hierarchy.
- The featured-card row synchronizer measures margin-box heights after resize and font readiness. Future CSS row-margin changes should be checked against CaseGridLayoutSync so alignment does not drift between one-word and two-word project titles.
- The Cinerific featured-card image now depends on cinerific_promo.png plus container-query height behavior. Future image swaps should verify the Cinerific crop against the Alla Vostra three-image stack height.
- The PrahL.dev card is intentionally half visible until hover. Future case-card opacity or hover changes should test that card separately because it is meant to read as less important than Alla Vostra, Cinerific, and Credit King.
- The Alla Vostra dedicated-page GitHub buttons now use a local SVG mark rather than the landing-page component. Future GitHub-button visual changes should update both surfaces

deliberately if exact parity is desired.

- Continue treating future Portfolio work as local-only unless the user explicitly asks to commit, push, deploy, publish, or update the public website.

Output Artifact

- Generated file: portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf.
- Location: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention: portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf. No part suffix was used because this is the first July 30 Portfolio worklog artifact.
- Uses the same daily worklog structure and compact technical voice established by portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf.
- Generated with a small standard-library PDF writer; no external PDF dependency was installed for this artifact.
- The local project date used for this filename and title is Thursday, July 30, 2026 EDT, matching the machine and repository work-session clock. UTC response headers during validation were already Friday, July 31, 2026, but the user requested the U.S. Eastern date convention for this worklog.